

clear picture. One expects better remedies to correct the economic chaos created by successive politicians since Independence. D.D. PANSE, *on e-mail*

Let Junta Rule

There is no reason why the monks, who are supposed to lead an ascetic life, should get involved in political activities ("Battle for Burma", October 15). Also, why has the US dubbed developments in Burma, a reclusive nation of monks and pagodas, a threat to South-Asian security and prodded India to play an active role? If the US can hobnob with the Pakistani General, why can't India do the same with the Burmese? K.P. RAJAN, *Mumbai*

Wily Dragon

One just cannot trust the Chinese ("Creeping Aggression", October 15). They attacked us and took away parts of our country when we were chanting "Hindi Chini Bhai Bhai" in 1962. And now when talks are on for resolving the border dispute and trading issues, there are reports that they are yet again making intrusions into our territory. They have proved to be a dangerous neighbour. RAMESH AGARWAL, *Kanpur*

Intruding into our territory is a way of keeping India under pressure and stalling its development. A strong India has always given China a reason to worry. VIRENDRA K. TANGRI, *Dehradun*

The Bolder the Better

The fact that Rakhi Sawant has been featured in the

magazine and has enjoyed coffee with Karan, shows she has arrived and that too, on her terms ("Drama Queen", October 15). Unlike others, she does not have a holier than thou attitude and has never let anything dampen her spirit, despite several taunts and sniggers. JONAKI BHATTACHARYA, *Pune*

Fast and Irrational

DMK has always acted like a bunch of comedians ("The Fast and the Furious", October 15). Karunanidhi

and his men sat together for a couple of hours, suspended all work and then left citing a judicial order. The fast was a farce. Most people kept indoors fearing violence. There was a complete breakdown of constitutional machinery. What Karunanidhi demonstrated was that power in the hands of irrational people can have disastrous consequences and not even judicial propriety can halt it. T.S. PATTABHI RAMAN, *Coimbatore*



Nail-biting finishes have ensured that Twenty20 games can be played only by the physically fit and watched by the medically fit ("The Future is Here", October 8).

This form of cricket is here to stay.

ANJUM SAMEL, *on e-mail*

The T20 win has made the world sit up and take notice of the country's youth brigade. However, the reception of the team and the shower of cash and goodies was overdone. Moreover, the washout at the hands of the Australians in the ongoing one-day series has made one wonder whether the success was a flash in the pan.

H.R. BAPU SATYANARAYANA, *Mysore*

The T20 Cup win should help the seniors realise their worth and put a check on their efforts to infiltrate the team on the basis of their past records.

RAJINDER GULATI, *Ludhiana*

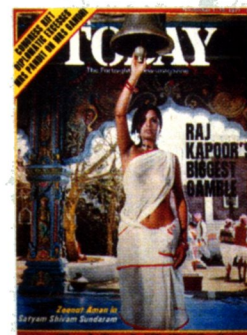
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The Kapoor Erotica

Few films have had such a ballyhoo as Raj Kapoor's *Satyam Shivam Sundaram*. At every stage of its production, the multi-million colossus has kept the tongues wagging within the film industry. Rivals are busy spreading stories that Kapoor has lost his touch; and an eager public, their curiosity aroused by stories of eroticism wait to see if it will prove to be a hit such as



The film's still *Bobby* or a flop like *Mera Naam Joker*. Kapoor by his own admission knows that this film will either cement his position as the godfather of Indian cinema, or be relegated to history books. The film was originally planned to be a low budget quickie. But as the idea evolved, Kapoor found himself injecting greater depth to the scenario. The old "beauty is only skin deep" concept gave way to a more philosophical thesis: that reality is not necessarily solid but that one's perception dictates its concept.

—Vir Sanghvi